

Veteran Connect

Phase 1 Product Scope and Compliance Foundation

Document status	Working source-of-truth for Phase 1
Version	0.1
Prepared for	Veteran Connect post-1 July 2026 MVP build
Framework	Improved MRCA / VETS Act-first PI claim preparation
Last reviewed	11 May 2026

1. Product decision

Locked Phase 1 decision

Veteran Connect version 1 will be built as a post-1 July 2026 improved MRCA / VETS Act-first PI Claim Starter Pack platform. It will support evidence preparation, condition intake, accepted-condition history capture, evidence gap tracking, AI-assisted draft documents, doctor preparation questions, and DOCX/PDF claim starter pack generation.

The app is designed as a GARP M-aware evidence and document preparation assistant. It must not present itself as a GARP M score calculator, compensation estimator, legal adviser, medical adviser, DVA decision-maker, or claim success predictor.

2. Product definition

Veteran Connect is a post-1 July 2026 improved MRCA / VETS Act-first evidence and document preparation platform for Australian veterans preparing permanent impairment claim material.

- Organises condition information, accepted-condition history, worsening details, evidence, functional impact notes and medical appointment questions.
- Generates draft claim-support documents for review by the veteran, doctor, advocate or support person.
- Uses GARP M concepts to guide evidence collection, without calculating impairment points or compensation.
- Keeps medical, legal and DVA decision advice outside the app boundary.

3. Official context used for Phase 1

The build should be treated as post-reform focused. The official material reviewed for this Phase 1 package includes the VETS Act listing on the Federal Register and DVA reform pages on permanent impairment compensation and frequently asked questions.

Source	URL
Federal Register of Legislation - Veterans' Entitlements, Treatment and Support (Simplification and Harmonisation) Act 2025	https://www.legislation.gov.au/C2025A00017/latest

DVA - Permanent Impairment Compensation	https://www.dva.gov.au/about-us/inquiries-and-reviews/veterans-legislation-reform/veterans-legislation-reform-resources/permanent-impairment-compensation
DVA - Veterans' Legislation Reform Frequently Asked Questions	https://www.dva.gov.au/about-us/inquiries-and-reviews/veterans-legislation-reform/veterans-legislation-reform-resources/veterans-legislation-reform-frequently-asked-questions
DVA - MRCA Veterans and Dependants	https://www.dva.gov.au/about-us/inquiries-and-reviews/veterans-legislation-reform/veterans-legislation-reform-resources/mrca-veterans-and-dependants

Note: source references are included for product design and build scoping only. Current DVA and legislative sources must be checked again before release, before commercial claims are made, and before the app handles real user data.

4. MVP inclusions

Feature	MVP notes
Veteran account login	Firestore Authentication
Post-2026 claim workspace	Primary user workspace
Claim pathway selector	New condition, worsening, new plus existing, evidence prep, unsure
Condition intake	Diagnosis, symptoms, treatment, impact and stability notes
Accepted-condition history	Capture VEA, DRCA, MRCA or unknown background
Evidence checklist	Show uploaded, missing and confirmed evidence
Evidence upload	Private Cloud Storage with metadata in Cloud SQL
Evidence gap tracker	Core MVP value
AI draft veteran statement	Draft only; user review required
AI doctor questions	Draft only; doctor to review clinical matters
AI doctor request letter	Draft only; safe wording required
DOCX/PDF starter pack	Main export output
AI-use disclosure	Visible to users and in generated packs
Basic admin source/template control	Minimum viable maintainability

5. MVP exclusions

Excluded feature	Reason
GARP M score calculator	Excluded to avoid misleading or unsafe scoring claims.
Compensation estimate	Excluded until formal legal/compliance review and authoritative calculation logic exist.
DVA outcome prediction	Excluded because the app cannot know or guarantee DVA decisions.
Legal advice	Excluded; direct users to qualified advocates or lawyers where appropriate.
Medical advice	Excluded; direct users to qualified health professionals.
Doctor account portal	Later phase after veteran workflow is proven.
Advocate marketplace	Later commercial feature.
Direct DVA lodgement	Later only after compliance review.
Payments/subscriptions	Later after private pilot.

6. Supported Phase 1 claim scenarios

Scenario code	User wording	MVP behaviour
NEW_CONDITION	A new permanent impairment claim for a new condition	Collect diagnosis, symptoms, treatment, functional impact and evidence.
WORSENING_EXISTING_CONDITION	A worsening claim for an existing accepted condition	Collect previous acceptance, previous assessment details, what changed and evidence of worsening.
NEW_PLUS_EXISTING	A new condition where the veteran also has existing compensated conditions	Collect new condition material and accepted-condition history.
EVIDENCE_PREP_ONLY	An evidence pack for a doctor or advocate	Avoid claim assumptions; focus on organising information and gaps.
UNSURE	I am unsure	Guide the user through plain-English questions without making a determination.

7. First user journey

1. User opens app or web app.
2. User creates an account or logs in.
3. User sees and accepts disclaimer and AI-use notice.
4. User creates a new claim workspace.
5. User selects what they are preparing.
6. User enters condition details.
7. User enters existing accepted-condition history, if relevant.
8. User answers GARP M-aware evidence questions.
9. User uploads evidence.
10. App shows evidence gaps.
11. AI drafts veteran statement and doctor questions.
12. User reviews, edits and approves drafts.
13. User generates Post-2026 PI Claim Starter Pack.
14. User downloads DOCX/PDF.

8. Required first pathway selector

The first screen after login should ask:

What are you preparing?

1. A new permanent impairment claim for a new condition
2. A worsening claim for an existing accepted condition
3. A new condition where you also have existing compensated conditions
4. An evidence pack for a doctor or advocate
5. I am unsure

9. Required disclaimer wording

Primary disclaimer

Veteran Connect helps organise information and prepare draft documents for review. It does not provide legal advice, medical advice, financial advice, a DVA decision, a compensation estimate, or a guarantee of claim success. Any draft wording generated by the app must be reviewed carefully before use. Medical information should be checked with a qualified health professional. Claim strategy or entitlement questions should be discussed with an appropriately qualified advocate, lawyer, or DVA.

AI output warning

Draft only. Review carefully before use. This is not legal, medical, financial, or DVA decision advice.

Doctor-facing warning

This document is intended to help organise clinical information for DVA permanent impairment claim preparation. It does not ask the doctor to provide legal advice or make a DVA decision.

10. Core data objects

- User
- Claim workspace
- Claim scenario
- Condition
- Accepted condition history
- Question response
- Evidence item
- Evidence gap
- AI draft
- Generated document
- Audit event

The key stored values for the post-2026 pathway are:

Framework values

claim_framework = IMPROVED_MRCA_POST_2026

claim_scenario = NEW_CONDITION | WORSENING_EXISTING_CONDITION | NEW_PLUS_EXISTING |
EVIDENCE_PREP_ONLY | UNSURE

11. Phase 1 acceptance criteria

Acceptance item	Reason
Clear product definition agreed	Required before build Phase 2
MVP inclusions locked	Required before task breakdown
MVP exclusions documented	Required to control product risk
Post-2026 scenarios documented	Required for database and UI design

Disclaimer wording drafted	Required before onboarding screens
AI boundaries drafted	Required before AI design
First user journey documented	Required before wireframes
Core data objects documented	Required before schema design
ProjectLibre Phase 1 tasks updated	Required for roadmap tracking

12. Build handoff notes

- Use this document as the Phase 1 source-of-truth until it is replaced by versioned product requirements.
- Do not add scoring, compensation estimation or outcome prediction during MVP build without a separate compliance review.
- Use the ProjectLibre CSV in this package to update the project plan with Phase 1 subtasks.
- Before public release, re-check DVA and legislative sources because the post-1 July 2026 operating guidance may change.